

votes from the global nerd community. The contest will be open till March 15, and the winner gets free flight tickets to Tokyo and accommodation for the October 2009 Japan Linux Symposium.

We have a lot of questions. Are Mac or Windows machines allowed during the production of the video? Will judges prefer videos edited on Cinelerra instead of Final Cut Pro? Will the commercials actually be put to use over television networks? Whatever be the outcome, we can't wait to get our hands on the rejects.

Weight and watch...

The newest gadget to mesmerise the *Digit* team was strangely enough – a weighing scale. There was much excitement when someone discovered it in the downstairs warehouse and the whole team promptly marched down to review it. Now, we at *Digit* are really of different shapes and sizes. Some like Vijay tried the

ol tummy tuck before getting on, but it didn't work. Our stick figure (Aditya) was asked to remove his wrist watch, which significantly affected the reading – he weighed in at 45 kgs! Big boss editor (Raaabo) was a decent 75, but not entirely pleased. He said we'll 'weight and watch'.

DIGIT DIARY

KIDS IN MARYLAND TAKE THE

Kids fool traffic policing system

The smart people of Maryland decided to set up a traffic system that did not involve any

people. Cameras recorded speeders, and mailed them \$40 tickets with no real police officers in the loop.

The smarter high school kids at Maryland decided that they needed revenge on some people, especially the teachers. Armed with laser printers and glossy paper, they replicated their teacher's number plates and zoomed around town –

the teachers received tickets.

Since they are only high school kids, the officials are unsure if this new trend is a game or a prank. Some of the victims are understandably unhappy about the violation of their civil rights. The bewildered officials hope to control the situation before the activity becomes more widespread.



Opening ODF files with Microsoft Word

Open Document Format (ODF) is an open standard file format. OpenOffice.org and others use. File extensions include .odt (text), .ods (spreadsheet), and .odp (presentation). By default, Microsoft Office does not recognise these file formats. However, it is possible to open and edit these files after installing a plugin from Sun Microsystems.

For office 2003 users

If you have Microsoft Office 2003, simply download and install the Sun ODF Plugin. You can download it from here.

For office 2007 users

1. First you need to Install Service Pack 1 for Microsoft Office 2007.
2. Install Sun ODF Plugin for Microsoft Office.
3. Open ODT document via File > Open, or by double-clicking the ODT file and when prompted for the application to open it with, choose Word.

If you don't have administrator privileges to install software, you can try an online converter such as Zamzar or Media Convert. You can also upload ODT documents

to Google Docs or Zoho Writer. <http://rabspd.co.cc/archives/opening-odf-files-with-microsoft-word>

Best Five Online Image Editors

Image editing is always fun in Photoshop. With Adobe Photoshop Express, an online version of Photoshop, you don't even need to install Photoshop on your computer. We made a list of other online photo editors. Let's check out the top 5.

1. Picnik: This is undoubtedly one of the most famous online image editors. It has some great features like Layers support, Red-eye correction, Rotate, Resize, Exposure etc. It is tightly integrated with Flickr.
2. Splashup: Formerly Fauxto, it is a powerful editing tool and photo manager. Splashup runs in all browsers, integrates seamlessly with top photo sharing sites, and even has its own file format(.FXO) so you can save your work in progress.
3. Picture2Life: The site offers plenty of editing and special effect options-including collage and animation features. However, We found the interface to be little quirky. All the usual

features are present.

4. Snipshot: The interface is Super clean and simple. No signup were needed, and can output image to 6 different formats including psd. But advanced options like layer support were missing.

5. Pixenate: A fairly uncomplicated site and really simple interface is what sets pixenate apart from other sites. Although we found that it was not as powerful and fast. <http://www.technonix.com/comment.php?comment.news.202>

Useful Free Softwares

BurnAware

BurnAware Free is a free CD, DVD, Blu-ray Disc burning software. It is ideal for users with basic disc burning needs as backup, creating data, audio, MP3 music, DVD-Video discs and burning disc images. Free, easy to set up, it enables you to save your files to disc quickly and provides clean, flexible interface to help you complete your burning tasks much faster. It's 100% Free. <http://worldofy2j.blogspot.com/2008/11/burnaware.html>

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